

Cloud Cost Comparison: AWS, GCP, Azure

Like-for-like monthly cost of running the system on a public cloud, sized for a single institute of 200 to 300 users. No hardware to buy, billed monthly.

AMAZON AWS

₹5,600 / mo

approx. US\$ 59 per month

GOOGLE CLOUD · LOWEST

₹5,100 / mo

approx. US\$ 54 per month

MICROSOFT AZURE

₹6,200 / mo

approx. US\$ 65 per month

1. Monthly cost, item by item

What it pays for	AWS (US\$)	GCP (US\$)	Azure (US\$)	AWS (₹)	GCP (₹)	Azure (₹)
Application server (2 vCPU, 4 GB)	25	24	30	2,375	2,280	2,850
Managed PostgreSQL database	24	22	25	2,280	2,090	2,375
Disk storage, 60 GB total	6	5	6	570	475	570
Backups and snapshots	2	2	2	190	190	190
Data transfer out, about 50 GB	2	1	2	190	95	190
Total per month	59	54	65	5,605	5,130	6,175

Indicative on-demand list prices for the cheapest US regions, August 2026, converted at ₹95 per US\$. Indian regions (Mumbai) typically run 10 to 20 per cent higher. Taxes are extra.

2. What it costs over time

Period	AWS	Google Cloud	Microsoft Azure
Per month	₹5,600 · \$59	₹5,100 · \$54	₹6,200 · \$65
Per year, pay as you go	₹67,300 · \$708	₹61,600 · \$648	₹74,100 · \$780
Per year, with 1-year commitment	₹44,000 · \$463	₹40,000 · \$421	₹48,000 · \$505
Five years, pay as you go	₹3,36,000 · \$3,540	₹3,08,000 · \$3,240	₹3,70,000 · \$3,900

A one-year or three-year commitment on the server and database typically saves 30 to 40 per cent, in exchange for locking in that spend.

3. Practical differences

Provider	Notes that matter commercially
AWS	Largest ecosystem and the easiest to hire for. A simplified bundled plan (Lightsail) can cut this to roughly ₹2,800 per month if managed database features are not needed.
Google Cloud	Cheapest of the three at this size and the simplest billing. Sustained-use discounts apply automatically, with no commitment needed.
Azure	Most expensive here, but the natural choice if the institute already runs Microsoft 365 or has Azure credits through an education agreement.

4. Points to note before deciding

- All three offer first-year free credits of roughly US\$ 200 to 300, so year one may cost noticeably less than shown.
- Educational institutions can often apply for additional non-profit or academic credits from all three providers.
- These figures cover infrastructure only. They do not include anyone's time to manage it.
- Costs rise with usage. Adding institutes, students or heavy reporting increases the bill; the on-premise option does not change.
- Data leaves the premises. Confirm this is acceptable for your compliance requirements.

Summary. Cloud costs roughly ₹5,000 to ₹6,200 a month with no upfront spend, and gives you resilience, backups and scale without owning hardware. Over five years that is about ₹3.1 to ₹3.7 lakh, compared with roughly ₹47,000 for the on-premise Raspberry Pi option. Cloud is the better fit if uptime guarantees matter, if the institute has no on-site technical staff, or if you expect to grow well beyond a few hundred users.